

FALSIFIED IMPRESSIONS OF PARENTS -- THEIR CAUSE AND CURE

Greetings, my dearest, dearest friends. God bless each one of you. Blessed are your works, your thoughts, your endeavors, your lives, and even your mistakes. For they too, as you know, may become the great keys to freedom and reality and love.

Again let us talk about love. Let us once again remember that man without love is withering away. It is not the love that you receive that is the most important thing. It is the love force in your heart that is the spiritual life blood you need. It is the driving force -- in a good and healthy sense -- that gives meaning to life. Without this love capacity, your life will be empty, meaningless, shallow.

You all know -- and some of you may even have become aware of the fact -- that deep down in your soul, you find a craving for being loved. When this craving reaches your awareness, it is often confused with your capacity to love. However, these two are entirely different. It is very possible that a human being is consciously aware of his need to be loved, and yet his heart is devoid of loving. For the greater the need, the more is it possible that you are still selfish, self-involved, withdrawn, fearful, anxious, bound, and blind to the other person. The more you are in anxiety, bondage, and dependency, the less will you be able to love; the less will you be able to open that inner channel through which the life and love force can flow and lubricate your soul, so to speak. Without this lubricating force, inner drought cannot be prevented. This inner dryness makes you feel as though your life is senseless, regardless of the worthiness of your activities. Only with this unclogged channel to love, can you become free and thus fulfill your personal needs.

I have shown you many ways to unclog this channel. All these processes are thought, by some of you, to mean something other than spiritual development. It is what you call psychological search. Again and again you fall into the error of believing these are two different things -- the spiritual and the psychological. Forgetting these terms, however, you will have to see that without the so-called psychological problems resolved, you cannot be fully capable of loving.

Let us tonight approach your love capacity from still another angle, an angle we have gone into only in a cursory way in the past. I have given instruction and advice to some of my friends for their private work to investigate this angle. I believe that the group as a whole is now ready to approach their problems, their development, and their pathwork from this aspect.

We all know that the child's first impressions come from his first environment, in which the parents or their substitutes predominate, and whoever else may play an important role in the child's life. The child's evaluation is limited. The emotional experience gleaned from his parents is therefore a very distorted one. In other words, in the crassest case, emotionally he may experience his parents as either good or bad, strong or weak, admirable or despicable. But even if it is not that crass, he experiences certain aspects of them, certain tendencies only, while the rest of the

personality is not perceived. These limited impressions falsify the picture. This image you often unconsciously carry of them -- and which may be quite contrary to your intellectual view and opinion -- influences your actions, governs your reactions to life, to others, and to yourself. It also clogs up the love channel, the channel that makes you capable of loving, of experiencing others in their reality, of being in the center of your world.

This fragmented impression causes such unreality and such distortions, which in turn influence you in the way you later relate to others and to yourself. In the area of your life in which you have the most problems, you can be sure that there is a connection between this problem and your perception of either one parent or both or of someone else in your early surroundings. A certain impression is stamped, imprinted upon your soul, and you go right on reacting from this falsified imprint.

Hence, the remedy is first to become aware of what you really feel about all people of your family or those who stand in importance for you. Investigate this impression, and compare it with your intellectual view. And then begin to consider whether you really experience them as living, dynamic human beings or whether your impression is just a fragmented, limited aspect of a whole person?

When you feel hurt or angry about one of them, or both of them, in your anger, do you perceive them as groping, vulnerable, blind, troubled humans, or do they take on, in your emotional life, an awesome, strange, fixed, and therefore almost inhuman aspect -- something unalive, robotlike, something of which the manifoldness of a human personality is left out? Think about the term, human being. What does it really mean? Doesn't it mean a variety of often contradictory aspects? Doesn't it mean that a person can be good on one hand, bad on the other, if you must choose these terms? Can he not be reliable on one hand and unreliable on the other, selfish on one hand and unselfish on the other? But the child in you does not perceive that. For the child, it is either this or that, but never both. Therefore you do not perceive the reality of this human being who was your parent. You may know perfectly well in your brain that people can be both good and bad, etc., etc., but emotionally you cannot experience this truth, particularly not in regard to your parents. Your emotional experience is always either/or, and therefore you are not in the reality of the living dynamics, the manifoldness of the human being who was closest to you and of whom it is most important, for your own sake, that your impression and experience be as realistic as possible.

As long as you are in this falsification, you cannot cut the tie that keeps you from freedom, from independence, from loving, from finding yourself in your true strength. Oh, you may have managed very well in many ways, but where this tie is not dissolved by a perception of reality, you must have problems you could resolve, provided only that the tie is dissolved.

Therefore, as the first step, ask yourself: "How do I experience my parents? Do I experience them as human beings in their contradictions, their blindness, their manifold, often conflicting, mixed components?" Does the person whom you may have feared and hated most when you were a child, perhaps still exist in you as someone who cannot be hurt, is invulnerable just because he hurt your vulnerability? This phantom creates havoc with your life. Often this is so, my friends.

You can become a free human being only after making revisions that constitute the second step, after first gaining awareness of your falsification. But how does this revision take place? First

begin by asking yourself, "What were they really like?" And try to understand them in the fullness of their being. Understand their lives, their inner and outer struggles, their own childhood as much as you know about it, what made them as they were, what were their own hurts and fears and frustrations. Understand them as a mature human being tries to understand another person, with as much detachment and objectivity as possible, considering as many facets and factors as is at all possible, not just certain aspects that have, unfortunately, singularly affected you. The seeing of only certain factors, leaving out others because you were not affected by them, always dehumanizes a person. Even if you glorify a parent, he still becomes inhuman in this unrealistic overglorification. The fixed and static view, due to fragmentation, becomes monstrous because it is not alive, not real. All the facts you have experienced from these limited aspects in which you perceive the entire person may be correct in themselves. But the truth is missing. It lacks all the factors that make up a whole human being. Only through wholeness can you understand the facts that have hurt and distorted you. Only in this understanding will the still hidden hurt and anger dissolve and set you free and unclog the channel to love.

You often shy away from revising your images of your parents. You may feel disloyal and guilty in stopping to glamorize an adored and idolized parent. You feel it your duty as a child to continue. Nonglorification may often equate with disrespect, contempt, resentment, or hate (in your unconscious mind, of course). It may very well be that under this glorification exists a fear, and under the fear a hate. You may protect yourself against facing this hate by maintaining an exaggerated glorification. This may be due not only to what the world seems to demand of you, but also to the fact that you may need this parent -- symbolically and in a displaced way -- even now.

Another reason for maintaining your glorified image of a parent is that he may have been a substitute for the only love, acceptance, and security you have ever known. To your unconscious mind, it would seem that you have to give up this love, acceptance, and security when you give up the glorified image of the parent. By devaluating the parent, it seems as though you are robbed of the only value you yourself possess.

No wonder you resist revising your image of your parents! By the same token, you may have an equal "interest" in holding on to a hated image. Why would you want to do that? It may be your very protection against yourself. If the parent remains bad in your eyes, then the slight and hurt he has inflicted on you becomes nullified, as it were. You fear, erroneously of course, that by seeing him as human, the hurt was justified, and your own value is thus diminished. Of course, there are other variants to this that have to be found and experienced by each one of you in your individual work.

Moreover, it is so much easier for the child in you to have everything well-ordered. To deal with reality -- which is flexible, contradictory, and for which there are no fixed rules -- is something that you would rather not cope with. So it may seem so much easier to have your fixed impressions where each person fits into a niche, where this is this, and that is that. Each is a static image, and this gives you a certain unrealistic sense of order and security. You know where you are at. However, the price you pay for this precarious order and security is something you cannot as yet evaluate.

So when you begin to revise the people of your early environment, and want to see them with your mature outlook, and want to understand them in their reality, you may find a certain fear and

resistance to do so. Note it. Become aware of it. Realize the significance of it. Understand that this is the very indication that therein lies a deep and important key of your life and of many problems that you probably never thought could have anything whatsoever to do with it. Only after you come to terms with this resistance by strengthening and fortifying your will, by asking in prayer, in meditation that you want to see the truth about them, will the resistance gradually weaken. There is no better prayer than one of this kind. I always say, use your current resistances and stumbling blocks on this path in a most specific way, in your prayer.

Psychological work is nothing else but finding out the truth about yourself and about others. Many times we have discussed that you cannot see the truth in others if you do not see the truth in yourself. But sometimes, at certain stages on this path, after a certain amount of truth about yourself has been brought to consciousness, it must also be tackled from the other side -- that is, from the desire to see the truth about others (your parents and siblings, for instance) in order to gain more truth about yourself. The desire to see the truth about them, their lives as such, their personalities in their whole dimension will give you insight and understanding about your own life and what governed you, what paralyzed you, what conflicted you. Needless to say, this understanding is the prerequisite to the cessation of these unproductive patterns.

The next thought on your part may very well be, "This is easily said, but not always easily done." Apart from your own resistance, you may not have the necessary information and knowledge about them to revise your image. They may be dead, and even if you can contact them and find out about them, there may be certain factors you cannot possibly discuss with them. So how can you revise your image? However, if you truly wish to do so, you will succeed. Of this you can be sure. You may find a way to learn more about them out of an entirely new attitude. You may seek out a contact that will reveal certain information about their lives, about other aspects of their personalities you have never seen or known about, so that they become more human for you. Eventually, after you have freed yourself to some degree of the old tie, you may even bring yourself to communicate in a spirit of truth with a still living member of your family with whom you might never have dreamed of communicating. By trying to understand their problems, your own hurts are bound to diminish. But first you may have to become aware that a hurt exists!

But what about a case where the parents are no longer alive. Often someone else may still be near you who might have a different slant on them, who might complete the picture for you, even by adding his own, but different distortion to the whole picture, perhaps a sibling, a relative or friend. But apart from this and in addition to this so as to be able to have the courage to take the necessary steps, you need still another approach. This approach is the sincere will, manifested in sincere prayer, to which the answer will come. God's ways are so wonderful. If you are but willing to want to understand what made them the way they were, what were their motivations for much that you could never understand, comprehension will come to you in the most miraculous way. Even if you have absolutely no one who knew them, incidents will occur to you that you had never evaluated in their true light. Perhaps you will remember certain aspects of their lives which had been related to you but which you had put away and not included in your perception of them. All of a sudden, these incidents or factors will take on a new meaning, thus enabling you to evaluate their persons in a different way, with the detachment and objectivity of one uninvolved human being toward another. When this process is started, your entire outlook will gradually be revised. It will not eliminate the facts you have experienced, but the experience will have a different meaning and thus let you free.

Before all this can happen, you have to be aware of what you feel, how you experience them, how you have been hurt underneath a possible veneer of indifference. And then the desire to see the truth has to be cultivated. You have to determine whether or not you inwardly desire the truth in this respect. As long as you are aware that you reject a truth -- any truth, this or any other -- you must be in bondage and confusion and unreality. This knowledge will help you. You will not force the issue, but in an organic way, the resistance will wear out, provided you do not push the matter away altogether. If you can acknowledge to yourself that you wish to maintain a falsified picture, a distortion, that you do not wish truth, the rest will come by itself.

If you say, "I cannot find out," ask yourself if this does not mean "I do not want to." Even if you think you cannot, make yourself wholly open for the desire to understand the truth. Without truth, there cannot be love. And without love, there cannot be truth.

Try this new approach, and your life, your problems, your relationships will take on a new meaning, my friends.

Are there any questions regarding this subject?

QUESTION: When parents give the child an unreal, or perhaps real, feeling of rejection, the child feels unworthy of love and therefore establishes a pattern of self-rejection. How does one work through this even if one sees one's parents in reality?

ANSWER: It happens naturally and by itself. The moment you understand your parents, the sense of rejection will disappear even if they were cruel to you. In understanding what made them cruel, you will see it as their problem and will, perhaps for the first time in truth and reality, know that this had nothing to do with your unworthiness. So far, you know this in your intellect, but emotionally you will feel unworthy so long as you feel your parents rejected you due to your unworthiness, and due to this sense of unworthiness, you are unable to establish constructive patterns that will give you reason to feel secure in yourself now. These patterns constantly confirm your unworthiness. You are thus unable to get out of them until and unless the basic understanding exists.

In the child's perception, the parents are somehow powerful supercreatures. It cannot occur to the child that these are human beings who grope with their own problems, who struggle with their own puzzlement of life. When real inner understanding of this truth occurs, the sense of their rejection of you must disappear. It may have happened frequently in your life, even before you were on this path, that you first felt rejected or slighted, and by a variety of circumstances, you found out certain factors that you had previously ignored. The moment you realized this, you no longer felt rejected. You understood that it had nothing to do with you, with your unworthiness. The act remained the same, but you no longer interpreted the act in the personal, self-diminishing way. The same happens with your parents. The moment you experience them as the living reality they were -- at fault, of course, but you experience them in their dynamics -- the impression and reaction must change in you. This does not mean you have to understand them completely and know everything about them. One never does, even with people one is close to. But I do not mean that. I mean that you destroy the limited, rigid, robotlike aspect in which you emotionally experience them. Then they will become alive. You will understand at least some of their problems. You will understand that

they could not have acted any other way, considering them as they were at the time, just as you could not have acted otherwise in the past although you may now recognize the error. The moment you have this understanding, it will automatically no longer cause self-rejection.

Your question is an important one. The answer will prove that in the last analysis it is the only way, at one stage of your development, to lose this sense of self-rejection. Then you will know without a shadow of doubt that it was never you who was rejected. The hurt that was inflicted upon you due to blindness, irresponsibility, undiscovered powerful currents of frustration and hurt on their part, had absolutely nothing to do with you, but was a result of their groping, pathetic human struggle of living that is so valiant when viewed from the overall picture of human development. Do you understand?

QUESTION: I understand, but still when a child is set in this pattern of self-rejection and has lived his life in this way, the child is twisted and distorted and loves the rejection rather than the love to love. The mere fact of recognizing one's parents will not resolve this kind of conflict.

ANSWER: I do not say that this is the only answer. There is never just one cure-all. You have learned many other aspects of this pathwork that are of equal importance -- and they all have to be experienced. If self-rejection can be cured by other insights and changes of destructive patterns into constructive ones, so much the better. Then I still say that distortion of truth must affect you and ought to be remedied. However, just for the very problem you cite, this topic is a most essential one.

The moment you experience the important people of your early environment in their reality, there will no longer be a need to love self-rejection. It is only loved because the child in you believes there is nothing else. But the moment it is perceived that you were not rejected because you were unworthy, you do not have to love your rejection any more. Don't you understand that?

QUESTION: I will try.

ANSWER: Yes, you have to try it. You see, there is often such a strong resistance to see the reality in this respect. Your saying, "This would not help my problem," is one form of resistance and amounts to the same as saying, "I have no way of gaining understanding about my parents." I say, even if you now believe it will not help you in this or that particular problem, just approach it in a spirit of truth, regardless of whether or not it helps you. In your prayers, say, "Even if I do not understand why it will help me, I just want to see the truth as far as I am capable of it." If you work toward that understanding and toward recognizing your resistance to the removal of this wall, you will then convince yourself as to what it will do for you. You do not even have to understand it intellectually now, how this could influence your self-rejection. Just approach it from the spirit of truth, truth about people, these people who happen to have been your parents.

QUESTION: Would you care to elaborate on the psychological background of the Fourth Commandment?

ANSWER: Yes. As usual, there are many levels of interpretation. I assume you brought this up in connection with our topic, did you not?

QUESTION: Yes, I also wanted to ask about the psychological background of the seven mortal sins. But I assume we can't go into that now?

ANSWER: No, let us wait with that for some other time. For that, we might need an entire lecture, and it may be a good topic indeed. We can also do it when we have a question-and-answer session, and you may then present each mortal sin as one question. I will go into detail about each one separately.

As to the Fourth Commandment, it is often so misunderstood, and so much harm has come from these misunderstandings and superficial interpretations. In this case, the force and guilt make love and honor into something compulsive that destroys real understanding and subsequent real love and honor. In blindness, you cannot respect and love when practically all you see may be undeserving of such love and respect. When you squash these impressions and superimpose artificial, compulsive love and honor, you are even further removed from true love and respect. However, the real meaning is exactly what I have said. See the truth. For if you do so, then you respect the basic human being in everyone, regardless of how many aberrations and blindnesses may exist.

QUESTION: But how long will it take for humanity to derive the real meaning of the Fourth Commandment? We usually have to learn for a whole lifetime in order to correct such mistakes and distortions.

ANSWER: How long will it take for humanity to correct all distortions of truth -- not only about this particular Commandment, but of any other divine truth that has reached mankind? Any truth can be distorted, you know that. When mankind has progressed sufficiently in his development, this will no longer happen. In order to get to this development, the error has to be gone through and dissolved. Self-awareness has to be raised, and then little by little, these distortions will vanish. You often seem to believe that the distortions have to disappear before you can develop it. It is just the opposite. The distortions exist because of your relatively low level of awareness of reality. As such, the distortions themselves are the remedy, for without them, you could not come to perceive truth. I said this so often, and I say it again!

From a spiritual point of view, from our vantage point, one single person gaining truth within, in the sense of this pathwork, has an infinitely greater influence on the entire cosmic development than millions of people in error! This may sound like an incredible statement, yet it is utter truth, my friends.

QUESTION: Just a comment in connection with our friend's question of how long it will take. It happens that I have lived with children in neighborhoods where I saw delinquent parents, parents who were fallen or drunkards, yet the children had reverence for them only through acceptance and understanding. And I have seen children from well kept homes who were pampered, yet did not know the meaning of it.

ANSWER: Of course, this is possible. An otherwise delinquent person may have a special quality for the child and give him something he needs. Also, the child may be born free of this particular problem so that organically and naturally truth is perceived in this respect. No distortion exists here. But it is also possible that such reverence is unhealthy and false. If it comes out of fear,

guilt, appeasement so as to be protected, then it has nothing to do with the real understanding we are talking about.

Do not begin by trying to love and honor what seems impossible for you now. Begin by simply wanting to understand. The rest will take care of itself. Such understanding can often come only much later in life. The sting of fear, resentment, self-negation, self-rejection will vanish after understanding has been gained. And that is the real honor and love that one human being can have for another, no matter how erring this other person may be.

QUESTION: I have a question from a friend who is absent. The need for pseudoprotection originates in the creation of an image. Can this need still persist after the image has been dissolved and thereby contribute to the creation of a new image?

ANSWER: Of course, this can happen. Unfortunately this is what often happens in faulty or insufficient psychological treatment. Certain levels are reached, certain patterns are dissolved, but one does not go deeper. One leaves well enough alone, and therefore the root, remaining imbedded, may create another destructive pattern or another image. So it is always a question of the right procedure, to slowly but surely get to the roots, to the next level. And then, of course, this process will be stopped and prevented altogether. Then a constructive, realistic pattern can be established. Then the love channel is open. Then there is no more need for defenses, but the individual is open to life, to living, to loving.

QUESTION: Could you comment on the Lord's Prayer, particularly about the words, "Thy will be done in earth as it is in heaven." Could you tell us what "in earth" and "in heaven" mean?

ANSWER: A long time ago, I presented an interpretation on the Lord's Prayer, but since this was not done in the English language and also since my friends have progressed considerably since that time, I may come back to it some time and give a whole interpretation of it on a deeper level now that your understanding is a deeper one.

As to your question now, I will gladly answer it at this time. Earth and heaven, both are not geographical descriptions of life here and now, nor of life in the hereafter after your physical death. It means levels of your personality which automatically include any state of life, the physical as well as the nonphysical. The symbol for earth might be interpreted in many ways, but just to give a few examples, earth may be your outer life, the material life, physical life, physical actions, your deeds, outer facts and factors, in short, everything visible. For earth is visible for you, while heaven is invisible. The symbol of heaven, therefore, is all that which cannot be seen or perceived with the outer senses. It means your inner actions and reactions, your thoughts and feelings, your motivations. It means your soul and spirit. It means the psychological, emotional, and the spiritual levels of your being -- that which cannot be seen. You may very well act outwardly in the right way, but inwardly the motivations may be selfish, vain, unloving, cowardly. A person may conform to all the rules and regulations of church and society and public opinion and be faultless in his conduct, but that which may go on in his soul may be very opposite to divine law. And that is the heaven, the kingdom within that Christ has spoken of. If you are inwardly pure, if you inwardly let go, if you inwardly fulfill the will of God -- perhaps sometimes at the expense of outer approval from society -- by being true to yourself, having the integrity, courage and humility to stand up for what you really

believe, then you do the will of God. If you ask for this in your prayer, fully aware that this may be His answer, then you do the will of God in heaven and automatically also in earth.

QUESTION: In this connection, is it not rather significant that the first seven words of Genesis (in Hebrew) contain the words heaven and earth, just as in the Lord's Prayer. An interpretation is given of the word heaven (Hashamayim), as being composed of the words which mean fire and water. Can you tie this together?

ANSWER: Yes. Primitive humanity always took, and still takes, everything literally. Only through development, will you, mankind, see the deeper meaning which will make so much more sense. The symbols of fire are the fire of life, living, loving, enthusiasm, healthy activity, spiritual endeavor, courage, conviction one stands up for, strength that makes life a meaningful adventure. Water represents the emotions -- the flow, the state of being, a healthy passivity. Both healthy activity -- fire -- and healthy passivity -- water -- are processes of purification. Both fire and water can be cleansing processes, and both kinds are needed for an integrated healthy life. Both are forces in the universe which you can tap if you tune yourself into it by establishing truth in your soul. The combination of these two forces brings you into harmony with the state of being which would mean heaven.

QUESTION: Could you talk about so-called "masochism?"

ANSWER: A lot of this has been discussed in all the lectures, in all our work. If the entirety of these lectures are understood and the method of work is gone through, you will automatically gain understanding about so-called masochism, this tendency of self-rejection. In order to recapitulate in brief terms, I would say that the self-rejection we discussed tonight, for instance, and many times before may, in some personality structures, create a more active process of masochism. Self-rejection in itself is masochistic. But here it is a question of degree. As I have said before, if the sense of one's unworthiness is stronger than the corresponding healthy forces, the only pleasure derived from living is found in pain. I still do not mean physical masochism; the same may hold true on a psychic level and may never manifest physically at all. When it does manifest physically, it is in a very advanced state. Since this seems the only certain thing that one can rely on -- pain through rejection -- one hugs it, one does not want to give it up. Healthy pleasure seems hopelessly unattainable. In other words, masochism is a giving up. It is a resignation to the worst, which one tries to make the best of. If the ego is too weak to prove the world wrong, as it were, in that the person asserts his right to live, love, have pleasure, then masochism is the result. The world seems to deny your right of selfhood, and you give in, agreeing with the world and making a pleasure out of the pain -- but in a very wrong, unhealthy, self-defeating, and life-defeating way. Both giving in and going with the stream, as well as fighting, are healthy processes. And both can be distorted.

Of course, there are also other factors involved, too numerous of possibility to go into now, but on the deepest level, this core can always be found. But until this can be experienced through extensive self-finding rather than by being heard as mere words, many other levels have to be gone through. On more superficial levels, you will find self-punishment due to guilt. You will find the self-destructiveness deriving out of a certain inability to cope with problems, or the inner desire not to cope with them. All the processes of the images we have discussed and found are really processes of masochism because the images with their patterns embrace a negative tenet which must produce

a painful result, and are therefore self-destructing. If this is enjoyed on some level of the psyche, no matter how unaware of this enjoyment or satisfaction one may be, then we deal with masochism.

The real answer can never be found in words, no matter how true. Such words may be helpful indicators to open the way so that you may experience the truth yourself, but this is all they can be. That is why it is so often the case that when questions of this sort are asked, there is a feeling of letdown and disappointment with the answer. One expects liberation from the answer, and no answer ever can give inner liberation. Inner liberation can come only and exclusively from experiencing these words as truth, and this can only happen as a result of the step by step breaking through of your inner resistance. Your path will always lead exactly to where you resist most. If you have the courage to face this and cope with it, you can indeed shorten the path. But if you shy away from it, you are bound to make detours and come back to this point of resistance at a later period. Perhaps by then, it will have thinned out because the unnecessary pain you encounter due to not removing your problems will finally weaken your resistance.

So again I say to you, my friends, check yourself wherever you do find resistance accompanied by the desire to look away from it. That is the very point, the very threshold that you must go through at one time or another in order to become free, in order to unclog the love channel and to live a productive life in which you feel useful, in which you feel that you fulfill a meaningful part. Only by tackling that which you most want to shy away from will you find the door, behind which lies the answer. I cannot emphasize this strongly enough.

QUESTION: In connection with this, I have found that I have always shied away from sex. And I have discovered that it is a crime in my emotions. As I thought further, in reality sex is pleasure. So I found that pleasure is a crime. And so, all along the line, I have sabotaged pleasure and joy. Now although I see this, I know this, I don't know what to do about it. Can you give me a hint?

ANSWER: Yes, my dear. I believe the next step will lead you to the answer why you have rejected pleasure. You will then find that you reject pleasure because you reject yourself. Again I repeat that the words will never suffice. This has to be experienced in your emotions, and the continuation of this work will finally bring you this awareness. Now why do you reject yourself? The answer to this will derive partly from recognitions you have already made and which you will then tie up with this, and partly by new recognitions. Your rejection of happiness, joy, pleasure, life, and love is in reality nothing but a rejection of yourself. The understanding of this factor will, of course, be found in exactly what I discussed tonight. Begin to investigate what kind of human beings your parents were, as well as others in your family.

QUESTION: Of course in seeking to communicate we must resort to words, and unless we get to the meaning of them, they are lost. The word masochism is used. Along with it comes the opposite term of sadism. Modern schools of psychology rather use the word "algolagnia" to refer to both sadism and masochism, calling one positive, the other negative. How do you regard this?

ANSWER: This is perfectly true. There cannot be the one without the other. Both are one current of inflicting pain. The so-called sadistic person inflicts pain on others as a protection against the self -- a pseudoprotection of course -- while at times, the very same person may find it against his interest to do so. He may then come into conflict with his surroundings, or he may find it to his

disadvantage because he fears losing the person he needs, whose love and protection he wants. So he will invert this force that exists in him due to unresolved negative forces. He cannot simply dispense with it at will, something has to happen with it -- either it goes out to another person, or he directs it to himself. Only the dissolution of this force will stop either the sadistic and/or the masochistic current.

So these two forces are really one and the same. The only difference lies in the direction. In what direction they are used makes very little difference, in the last analysis, because if you hurt someone else, you must eventually hurt yourself. And if you hurt yourself, you must eventually hurt someone else. This is so because it must make you blind since this current derives out of blindness. It must make you un-understanding since this current derives from lack of understanding. The only difference is in timing -- who is affected first. The secondary reaction is then a delayed one.

Psychology has termed it in certain words. Spiritually this is absolutely true. There is this current of cruelty, of pain-inflicting, and no matter toward whom it is directed in the first place, it takes its toll eventually for all concerned. It is very shortsighted to believe that masochism indicates a better character trend than sadism.

I bless each and every one of you and all my friends everywhere. May you perceive, deep in your heart, deep in your understanding, what I said to you tonight, and may it give you courage and strength to pass through the closed door within yourself so as to gain light, safety, freedom, and a productive life. It is right there for the asking, so much closer than you think. All you have to do is extend your hand and relinquish your old pseudosafeties. Be in peace. Be in God!

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